Voluntary Report – Voluntary - Public Distribution **Date:** December 19, 2025

Report Number: BU2025-0024

Report Name: Oilseeds and Products Market Update

Country: Bulgaria

Post: Sofia

Report Category: Oilseeds and Products

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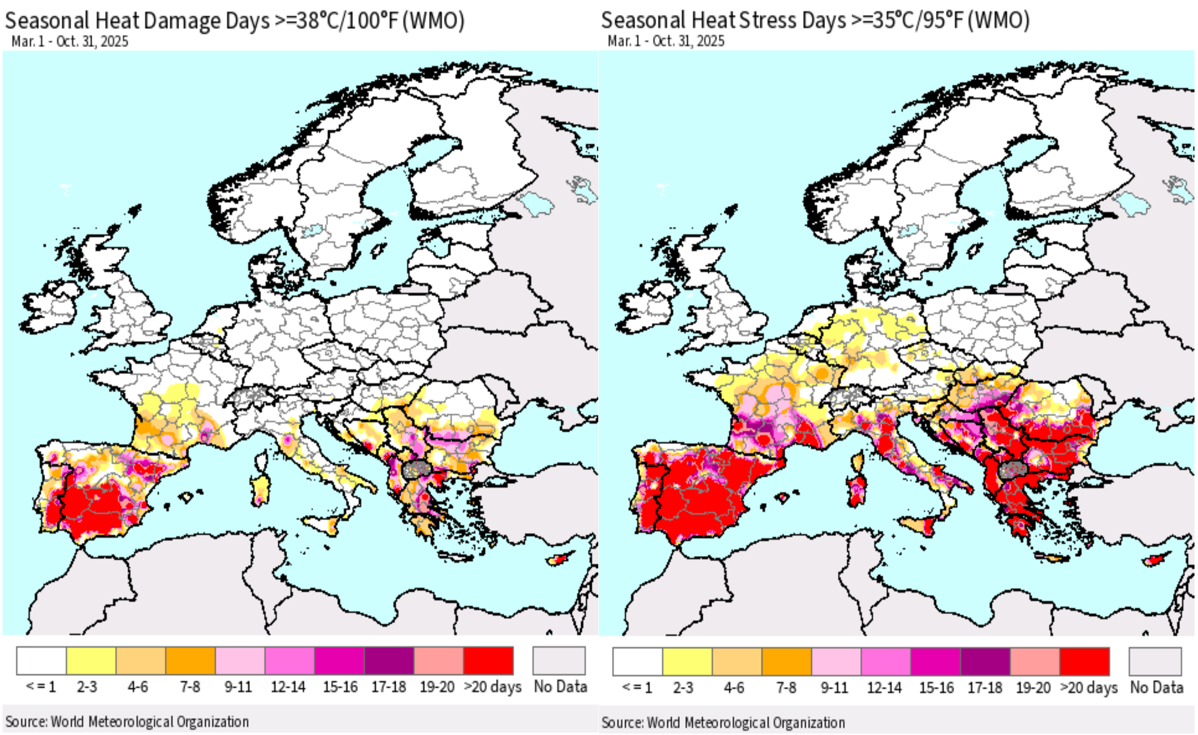
Report Highlights:

Bulgaria's sunflower production had another challenging year due to extreme summer heat and drought. FAS/Sofia reduces its marketing year (MY) 2025/26 sunflower production estimate to 1.66 million metric tons (MMT), very close to the MY 2024/25 level. However, as Bulgaria harvested higher than expected rapeseed crop, FAS/Sofia increases its estimate to 295,000 MT. This supply situation is forecast to lead to growth in rapeseed crush, and stagnant or slightly lower sunflower crush while exports of oilseeds will likely decline. The fall planting of MY 2026/27 rapeseed was completed in relatively good climate conditions with a substantial 35 percent increase in area planted and optimistic prospects for the new crop.

Weather Overview
In the last 3 years, extreme hot and dry weather during the months of July and August have negatively affected Bulgaria's sunflower crop, with severe impacts on yields, production, and farm income. Despite the optimistic start of the latest season, average yields were negatively affected (Map 1).

Map 1. Seasonal Heat Damage and Heat Stress between March 1 and October 31, 2025, Crop Explorer/USDA



Prolonged summer aridity persisted until late September. Scarce rain and warm weather provided favorable conditions for the early harvest of sunflower. However, this weather was followed by heavy rainfall and excessive wetness in October. Between September 1 and October 18, a precipitation surplus occurred in northern Bulgaria with rainfall up to 250 millimeters (mm) corresponding to up to 90 mm above the long-term average (LTA). Wet soils delayed the sunflower harvest, caused losses, and lowered yields and quality.

Rapeseed planting in Bulgaria began as early as late August, but dry soils persisted until late September, limiting early crop establishment. Crop emergence was uneven due to dry topsoils with some farmers reportedly reseeding due to dry fields. In October, heavy rainfall disrupted field operations. Intense precipitation at the beginning of October (over 150 mm in only a few days) caused soils to shift from very dry to overly wet conditions within a short period. This slowed planting, especially in northern Bulgaria, which in turn delayed the completion of the season. (JRC MARS Bulletin May Vol 33 №9, and Crop Explorer Bulgaria data). (See Maps 1-8 and Graph 6 in the Appendix).

Domestic Production and Supply

Marketing Year (MY) 2025/26

Farmers attempted to maximize both the rapeseed and sunflower crop area due to expected good profitability. Total production of oilseeds (Table 1) increased in MY 2025/26 by 8.3 percent over MY 2024/25, mainly due to a 6.1 percent higher area. The growth was thanks to the rapeseed crop which enjoyed expanded area, better yields, and improved production while sunflower production stagnated.

Rapeseed: Expanded area and favorable weather supported good rapeseed yields exceeding earlier expectations. The harvest was on time with favorable weather conditions, and the quality of the crop is reported to be excellent with higher oil content than usual. According to initial Ministry of Agriculture (MinAg) data (weekly bulletins), rapeseed production reached 289,000 metric tons (MT) from 103,000 hectares (HA) harvested area and average yields of 2.82 MT/HA. Industry production estimates vary from 280,000 MT to 300,000 MT. FAS/Sofia increased its production estimate to 295,000 MT (Table 1), 84 percent more than in MY 2024/25. This was due to higher average yields of 2.78 MT/HA, compared to 2.5 MT/HA last year, as well as 66 percent expansion in harvested area (Graph 1).

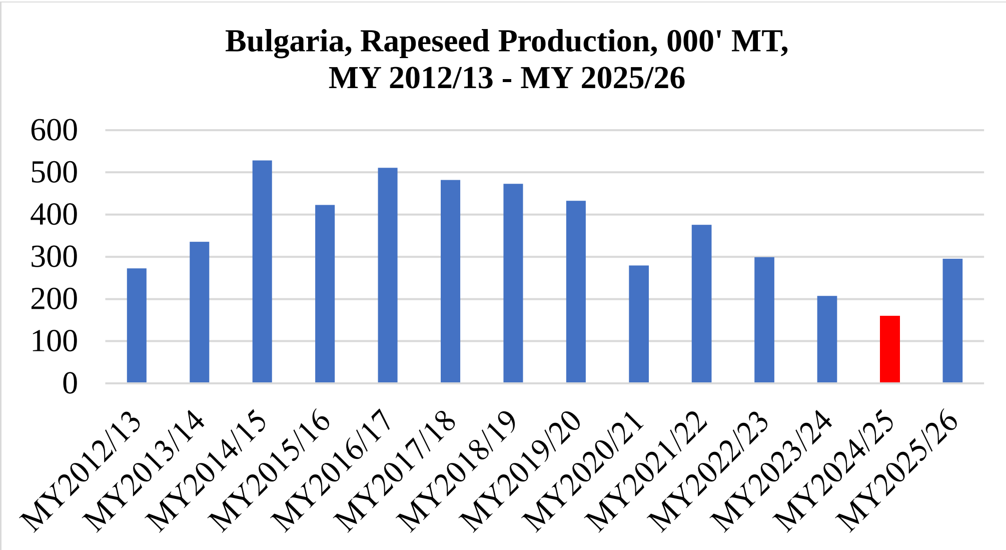
Sunflower: MinAg weekly data shows the sunflower harvest was completed by November 6, 2025, with average yields at the same level as a year ago at 0.157 MT/HA, harvested area at 945,000 HA, and production at 1.48 million metric tons (MMT). The European Commission's (EC) latest forecasts for Bulgaria (JRC MARS Bulletin May Vol 33 №9) show sunflower yields at 0.170 MT/HA, 2 percent below the MY 2024/25 yield and 19 percent below the 5-year average. Industry estimates for the sunflower crop vary from 1.45 MMT to 1.7 MMT. FAS/Sofia's current estimate is at 1.66 MMT, slightly above MY 2024/25 (Table 1), with harvested area at 948,000 HA (confirming FAS/Sofia's earlier forecast), and average yield at 0.175 MT/HA compared to 0.174 MT/HA in the previous season.

For most producers, sunflower was more attractive than corn as it is more resilient to summer weather risks and more cost-efficient, while domestic crush demand remains strong. This led to a 2 percent higher planted area from MY 2024/25, nearly reaching the ceiling of area possible for sunflowers based on crop rotation practices (Graph 2).

MY 2026/27

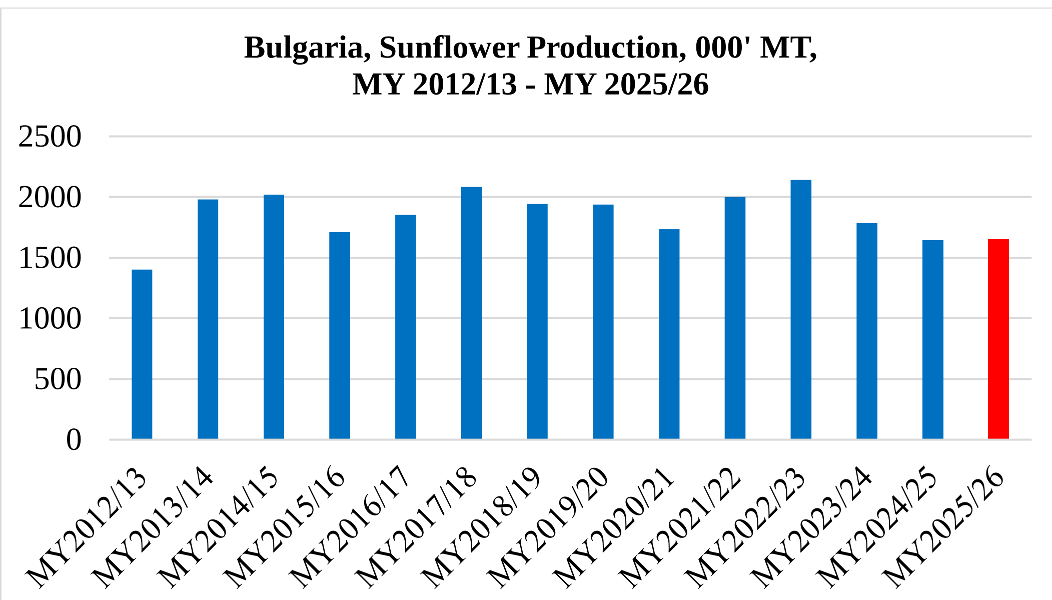
The fall planting of rapeseed occurred in relatively good but not optimal conditions (see the Weather section). Encouraged by attractive prices and good profitability, farmers made strong efforts to expand the planted area, following the substantial growth seen in MY 2025/26 over MY 2024/25. As of November 6, MinAg reported planted area at 137,000 HA, 34 percent more than during the same period a year ago. Industry estimates vary from 135,000 HA to 145,000 HA. Currently, the rapeseed fields are reported to be in good condition. Some farmers had to reseed fields due to the August-September dryness. However, wet October conditions improved the rapeseed development. The growth in area planted promises an increase in production, if the weather cooperates, to around or over 350,000 MT.

Graph 1.



Source: Eurostat, MY 2024/25 is FAS/Sofia current estimate

Graph 2.



Source: Eurostat, MY 2024/25 is FAS/Sofia current estimate

MY 2025/26 Domestic Demand and Trade

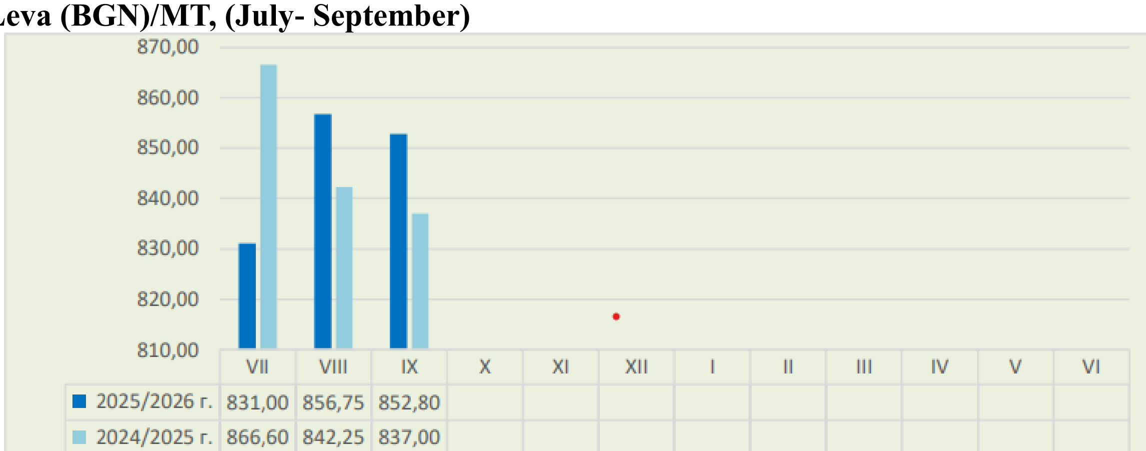
Rapeseed Crush:
Domestic rapeseed crush strengthened significantly due to the expansion of crushing facilities for biodiesel and a domestic and regional shortage of sunflower seeds. In addition, crush margins were better for rapeseed compared to those for sunflower seeds at this point in the current season. This has caused sunflower crushers to increasingly switch from sunflower seeds to rapeseed crush.

According to MinAg, the MY 2025/26 rapeseed crush (as of November 15, 2025) increased to 138,000 MT, 39 percent more than a year ago (99,000 MT). Most of the rapeseeds crushed were sourced from local supply due to the better crop. Imports were lower at 79,000 MT compared to 113,000 MT a year ago, mainly due to the higher domestic supply (Table 2). Conversely, exports are higher at 90,000 MT, compared to 61,000 MT a year ago (Table 2). As a result of the elevated crush, exports of processed products (rapeseed oil and meal) are also expanding over MY 2024/25. Dynamic crush demand drove prices sharply higher (Graph 3) and the rapeseed crop was reported as the most profitable crop for farmers this season.

Due to higher production and despite the increase in crush and exports, the stocks available in the middle of November are reported 14 percent higher than a year ago at 151,000 MT. This is expected to support growth in trade and/or crush in this season. It is still unknown if imports will remain elevated to complement local supplies due to the crush demand.

Therefore, the MY 2025/26 rapeseed crush may see more growth following the previous expansion in MY 2024/25 over MY 2023/24. According to official data (MinAg weekly bulletins), the Bulgarian rapeseed crush in MY 2024/25 was at 582,000 MT compared to 227,000 MT in MY 2023/24, an increase of more than double (156 percent). This led to higher exports of processed products, especially of rapeseed meal (Table 3). As Bulgaria exports most rapeseed meal as it has traditionally not used this product. Rapeseed oil remains on the domestic market for biodiesel production.

Graph 3. Bulgarian Rapeseed Monthly Market Prices, MY 2025/26 vs MY 2024/25 in Bulgarian Leva (BGN)/MT, (July- September)



*The chart shows prices for the MY, which begins in July, with MY 2025/26 in dark blue and MY 2024/25 in light blue.
Source: MinAg Monitoring of Commodity Markets Weekly Bulletins

Sunflower Crush:
With limited domestic sunflower seeds, crushers have made every effort to source price-competitive sunflower seeds both from domestic producers and imports. Processing capacities continue to expand to over 4.5 MMT (crush and de-hulling), driving demand and prices. However, imports face several challenges. This includes a regional deficit, as well as strong crush demand in traditional exporting Black Sea countries combined with their trade policies keeping seeds on the respective markets for strong crush demand. As a result, imports as of mid-November were only 73,000 MT (Table 2) or 43

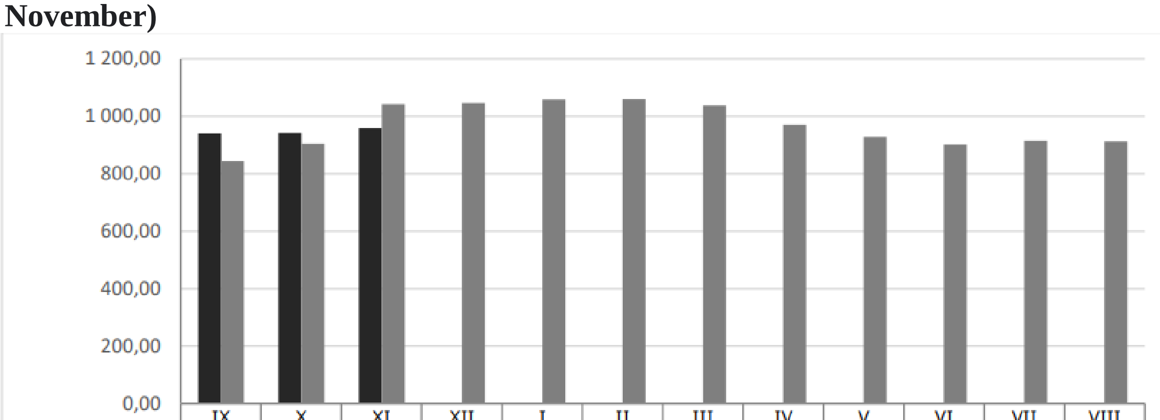
percent less than 129,000 MT imported in the corresponding period a year ago. This led to a 15 percent decline in crush to 321,000 MT (mid-November MY 2025/26) compared to 364,000 MT in the same period of MY 2024/25. According to the crushing industry, most factories operate at or below 30 percent of their capacity.

Farm-gate sunflower seed prices have increased, exceeding the levels of September and October of last year (Graph 4), but lower than levels in last November. Nevertheless, many farmers have been reluctant sellers while crushers switch to rapeseed. Prices are projected to remain volatile but elevated this season due to regional shortages and strong demand in main importing countries.

Industry sources forecast a possible stabilization in crush later in MY 2025/26 if exports of sunflower seeds decline. Currently, exports are small at only 16,000 MT although traders report good export opportunities to Türkiye due to a new reduced tariff rate quota for sunflower seeds. Türkiye is traditionally the largest export market for Bulgarian sunflower seeds due to high demand, geographic proximity, and easier export logistics.

Although official trade data is not available yet, MinAg weekly bulletins show MY 2024/25 exports of sunflower seeds were considerably higher by 26 percent to 322,000 MT compared to 255,000 MT in the previous season. Industry sources also confirm higher exports, mainly in the second half of the season, with Türkiye as the main market, followed by the Netherlands, Portugal, Romania, and Hungary. This was accompanied by a 45 percent growth in imports (724,000 MT in MY 2024/25 compared to 498,000 MT in MY 2023/24) which kept crush relatively stable at 1.61 MMT (MY 2024/25 vs 1.66 MMT in MY 2023/24). However, this scenario is unlikely to occur again this marketing year due to the smaller regional supply, which makes the role of exports of sunflower seeds of key importance for the domestic crushing industry.

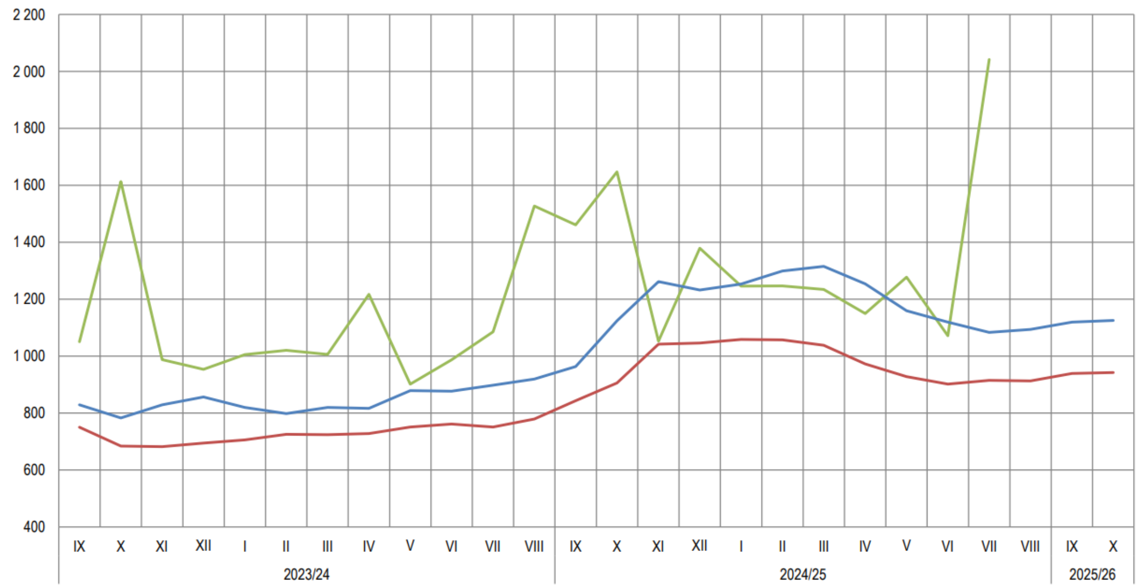
Graph 4. Sunflower Monthly Market Prices, MY 2025/26 vs MY 2024/25 in BGN/MT (September - November)



	IX	X	XI	XII	I	II	III	IV	V	VI	VII	VIII
2025/2026 г.	939,80	942,50	959,00									
2024/2025 г.	843,50	905,40	1 042,00	1 046,00	1 058,60	1 059,00	1 038,25	969,60	927,75	902,00	914,80	913,00

*The chart shows prices for the MY, which begins in September, with MY 2025/26 in dark black and MY 2024/25 in grey.
Source: MinAg Monitoring of Commodity Markets Weekly Bulletins

Graph 5. Sunflower Average Monthly Prices, MY 2023/24 – MY 2025/26, BGN/MT



Red line- Bulgarian ex-farm prices, sunflower seeds, in Bulgarian leva (BGN) per MT
Blue line – EU export price FOB Bordeaux, sunflower seeds, BGN/MT
Green line – Bulgarian CIF export price, sunflower seeds, BGN/MT
Source: MinAg Dashboard Grains and Oilseeds, November 2025

Appendix:

Table 1. Oilseed Crops Final Production Data MY 2025/26 and MY 2024/25, November 2025

Crops	Area Harvested (000 HA)		Production (000 MT)	
	MY 2025/26	MY 2024/25	MY 2025/26	MY 2024/25
Rapeseed	106.00	64.26	295.35	159.87
Sunflower	948.00	929.08	1,660.00*	1644.74
Soybeans	0.50	0.58	0.6*	0.63
Total	1054.5	993.92	1955.95	1,805.24
Source: Eurostat data based on EU standard moisture content- updated as of November 2025 *FAS/Sofia estimates				

Table 2: MY 2025/26 Trade in Major Oilseed Crops, as of November 17, 2025

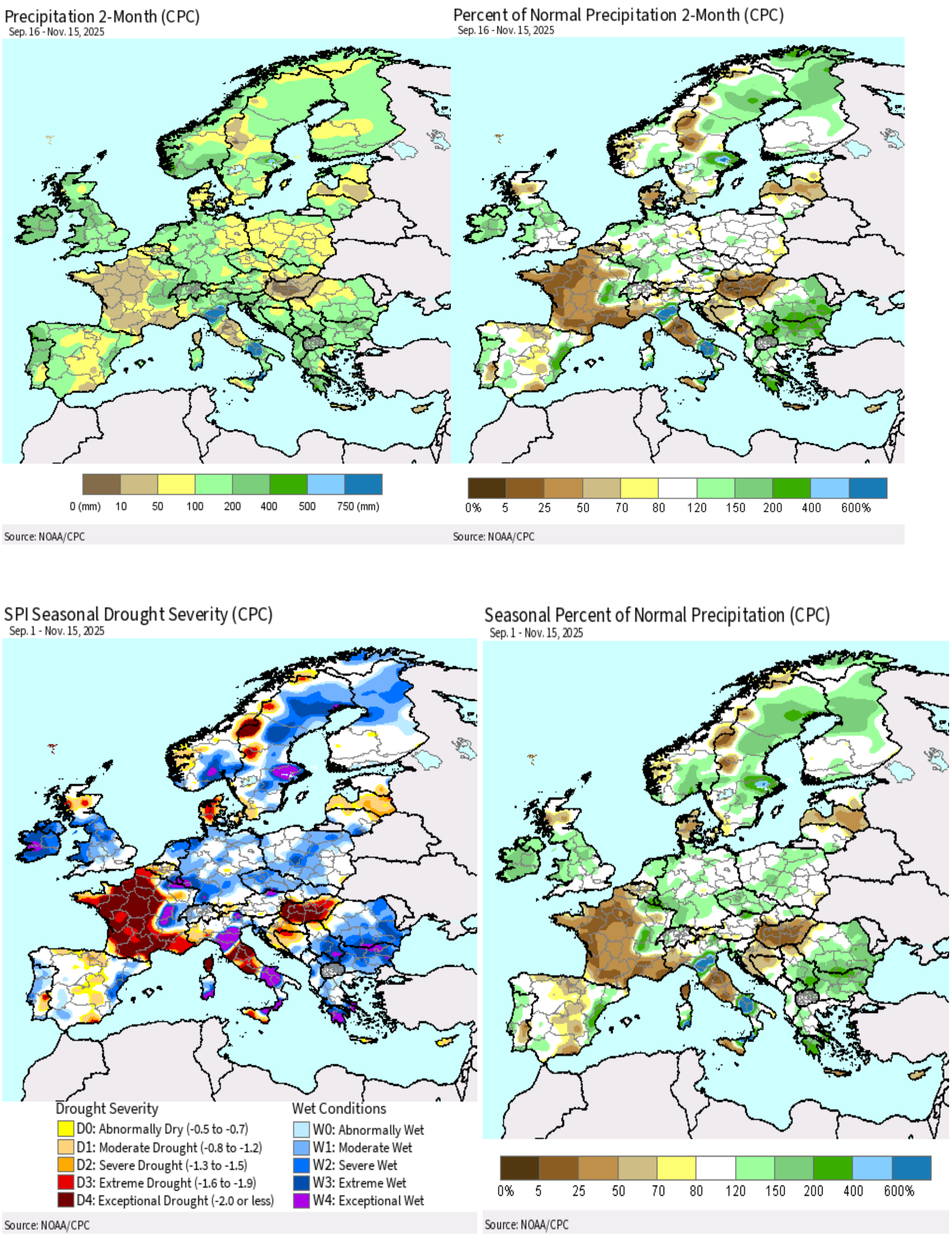
Types of Oilseeds	Imports, MT	Exports, MT
Rapeseed	79,285 MT	89,877 MT (all exported for the EU market)
Sunflower	73,340 MT	16,405 MT (all exported for non-EU markets)
Source: Ministry of Agriculture weekly bulletins. Note: MinAg uses September 1-August 31 as a MY for sunflower.		

Table 3: MY 2024/25 Trade in Rapeseeds and Processed Products

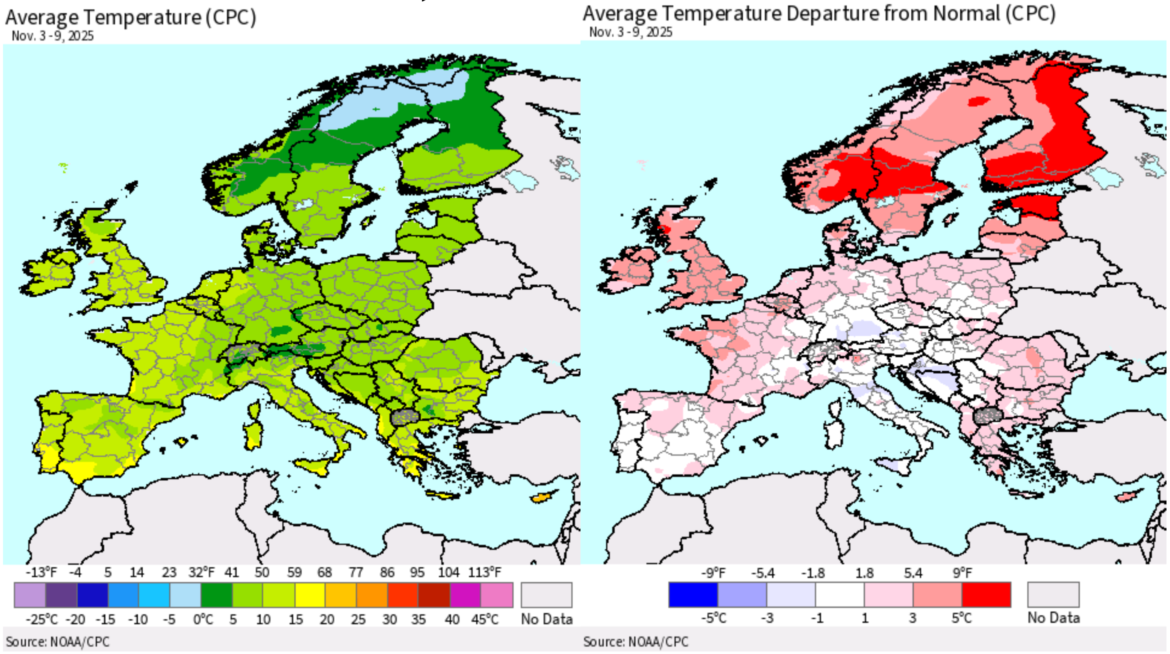
	Imports, MT	Exports, MT
Rapeseeds	368,708 MT: - 216,384 MT from	61,649 MT: - 58,354 MT to Belgium

	Canada - 71,015 MT from Romania - 32,121 MT from Moldova	- 1,931 MT to Greece - 1,186 MT to Romania
Rapeseed Meal	4,639 MT: - 4,578 MT from Romania	172,807 MT: - 67,157 MT to Spain - 24,334 MT to Israel - 19,789 MT to Ireland - 19,742 MT to the Netherlands - 18,185 MT to France
Rapeseed Oil	10,854 MT: - 8,387 MT from Ukraine - 1,624 MT from Romania	4,867 MT: - 2,532 MT to Greece - 1,575 MT to Spain
Source: Trade Data Monitor (TDM)		

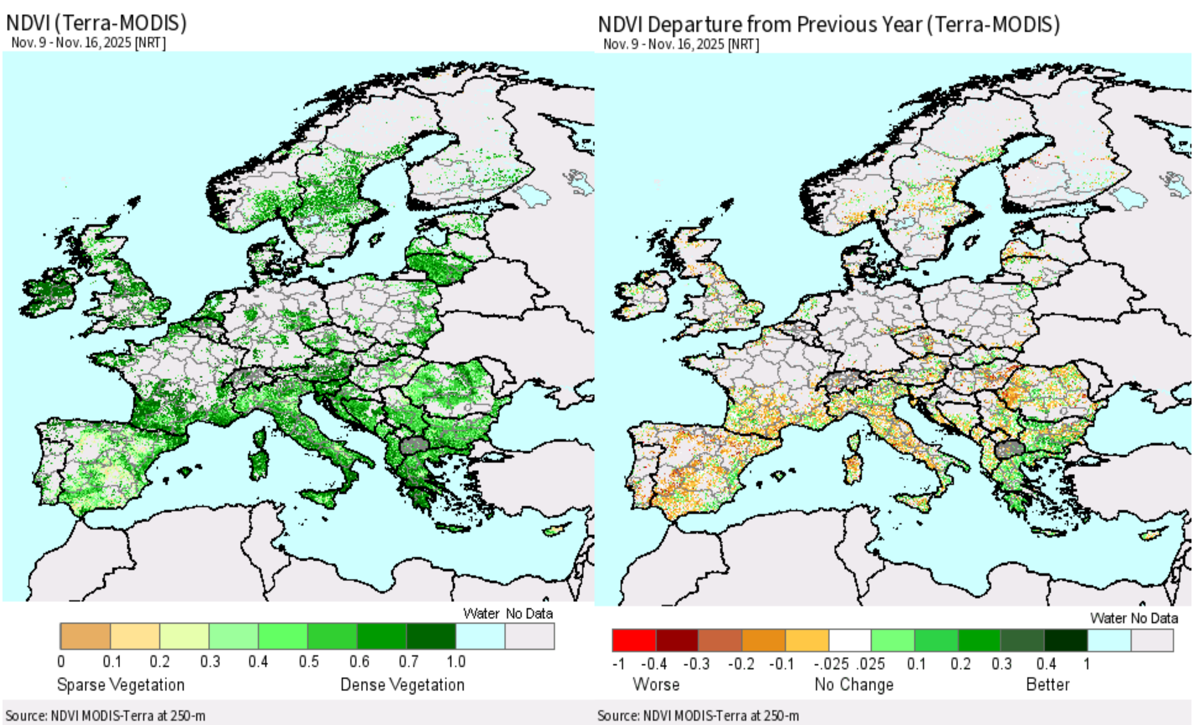
Map 2: USDA [Crop Explorer](), Europe (including Bulgaria), Precipitation and Percent of Normal Precipitation, September 16 to November 15, 2025; Seasonal Drought Severity and Seasonal Percent of Normal Precipitation, September 1 – November 15, 2025.



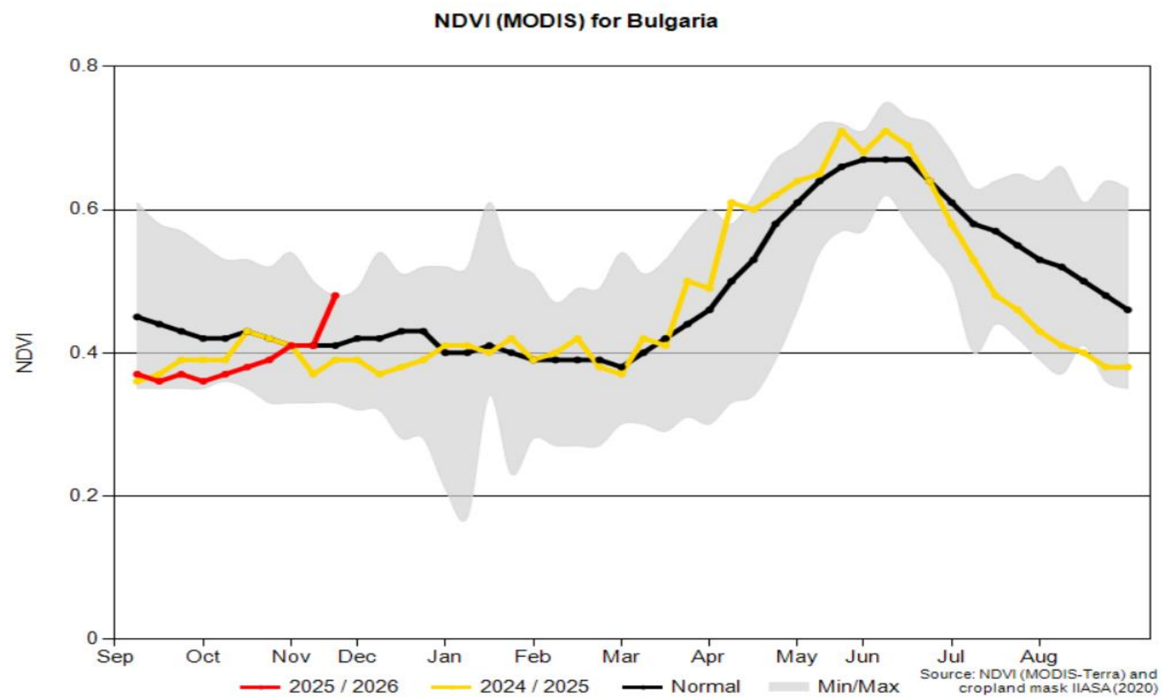
Map 3: USDA Crop Explorer, Europe (including Bulgaria), Average Temperature and Departure from Normal as of November 9, 2025

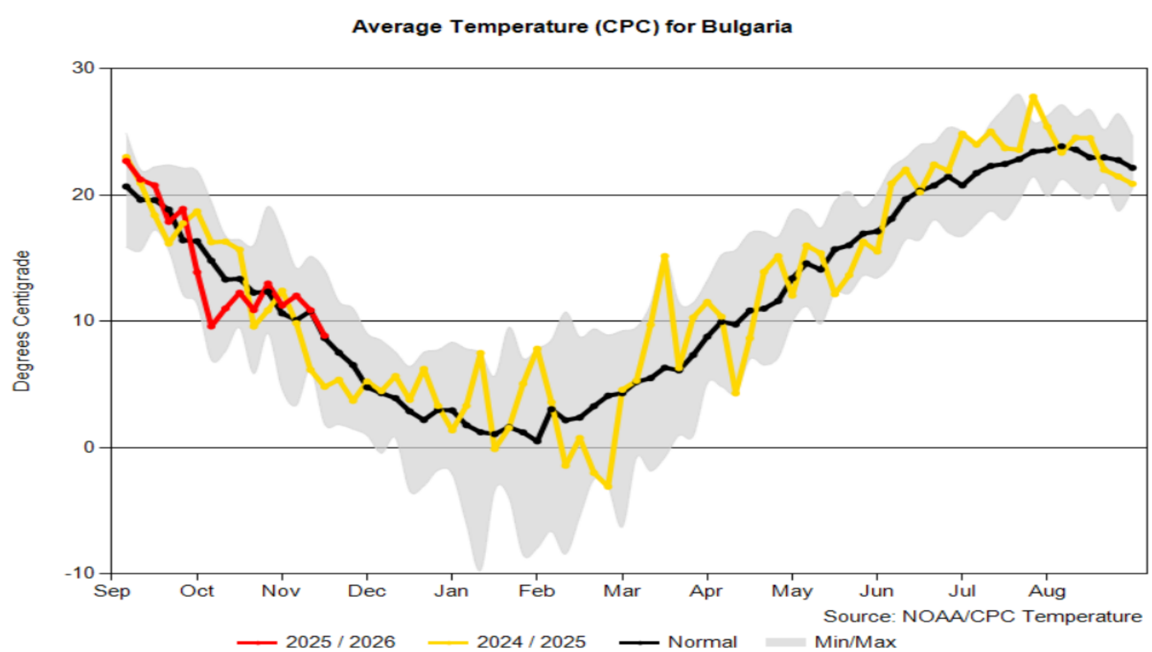


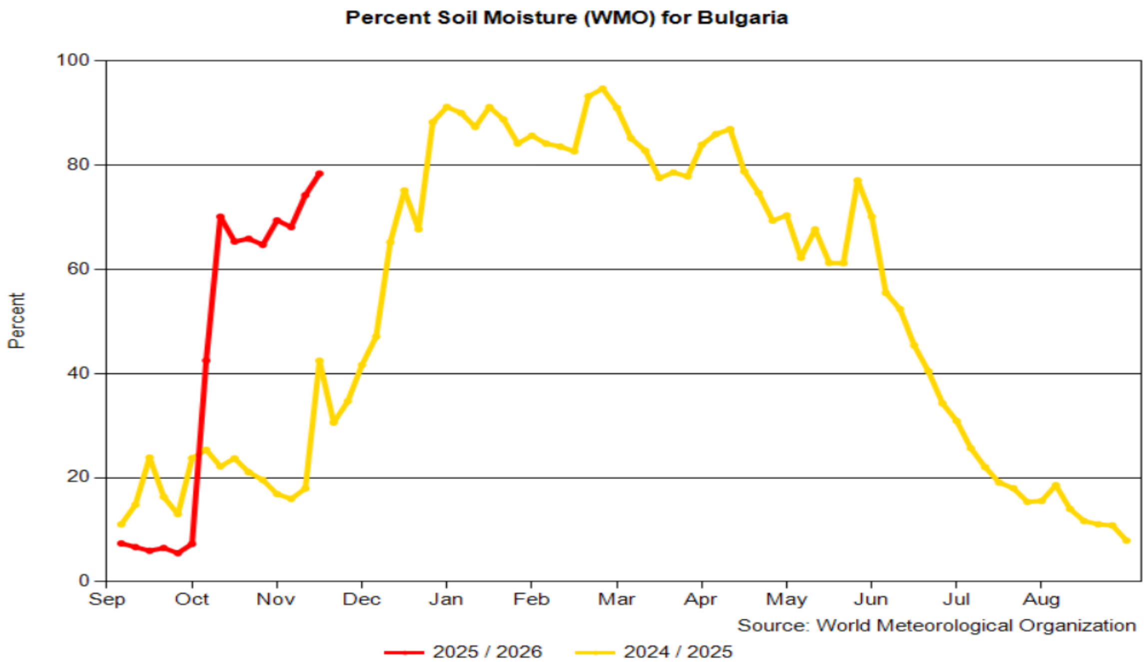
Map 4. USDA Crop Explorer, Europe (including Bulgaria), NDVI (Vegetation Index) for November 9-16, 2025 and NDVI Departure from the Previous Year

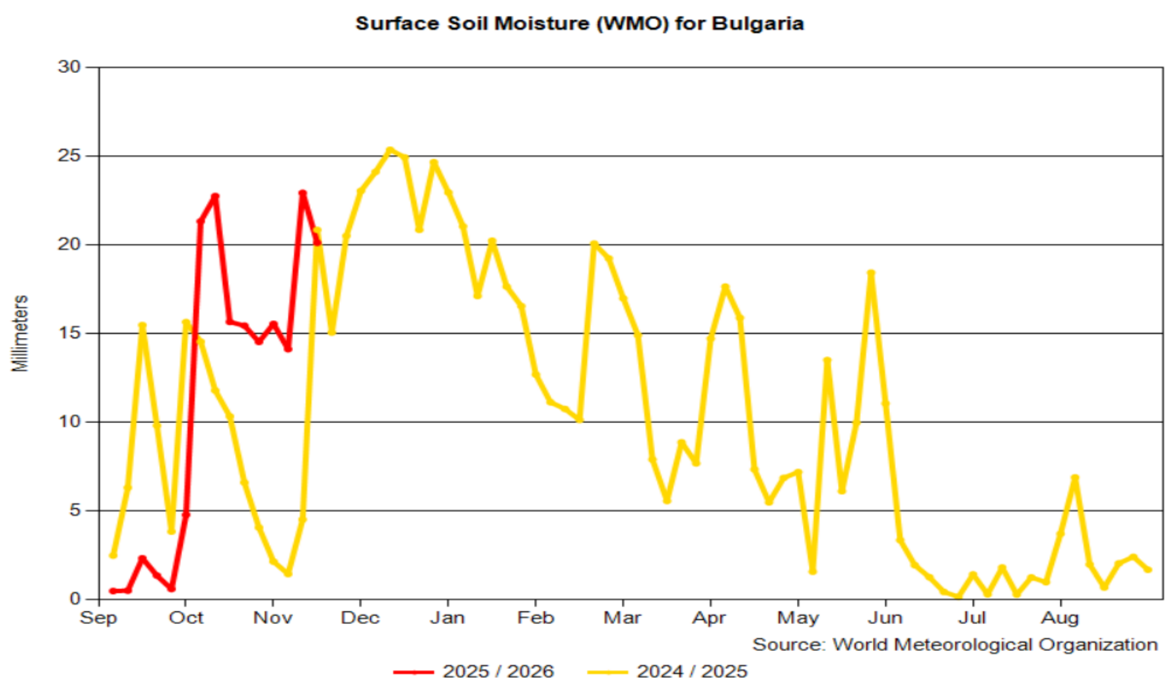


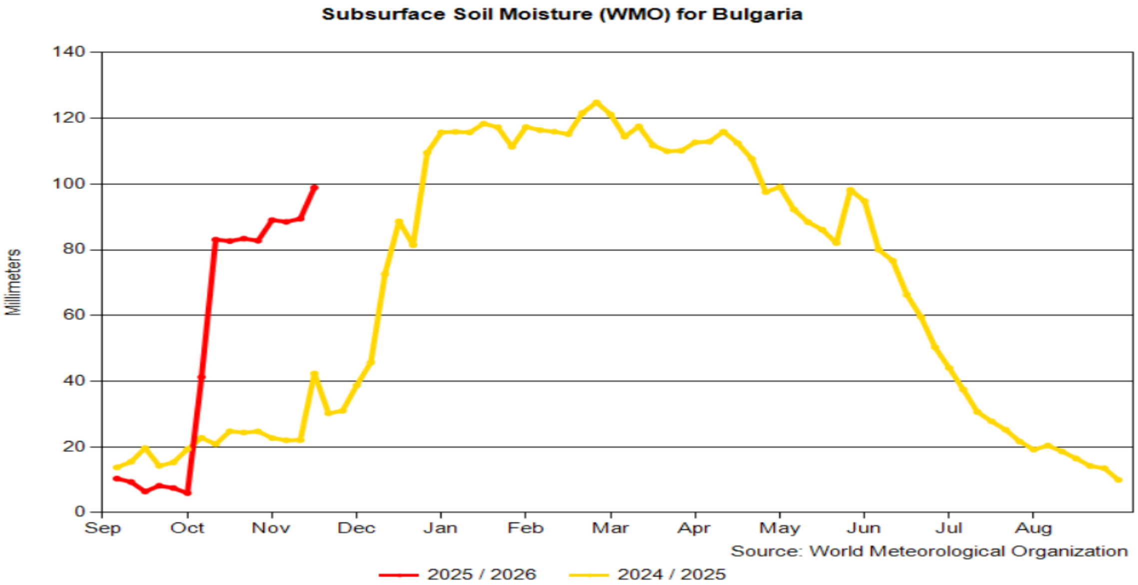
Graph 6. **USDA [Crop Explorer](), Bulgaria, Vegetation Index (NDVI), Average Temperature, Percent of Soil Moisture, Surface and Subsurface Soil Moisture, as of November 15, 2025**



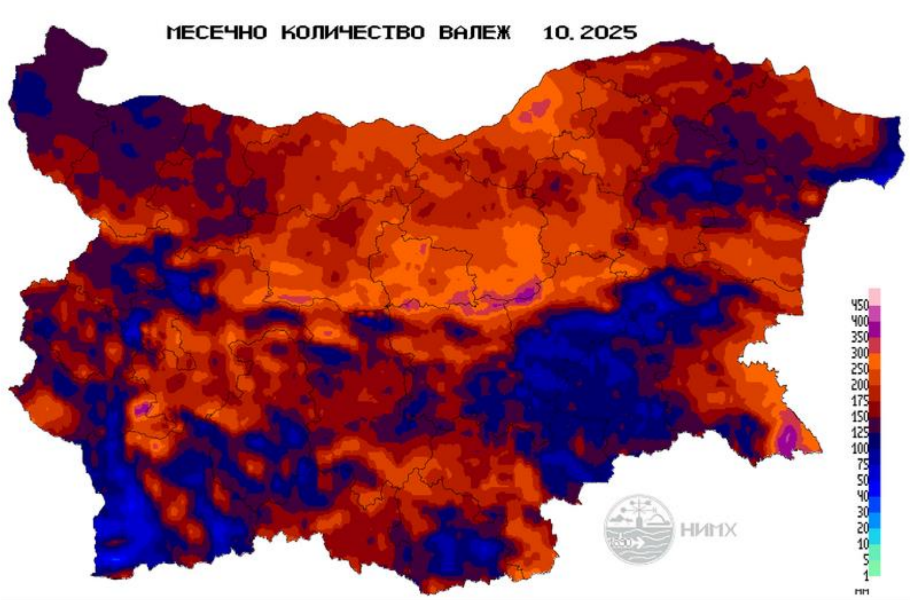



Percent Soil Moisture (WMO) for Bulgaria
Percent
100
80
60
40
20
0
Sep
Oct
Nov
Dec
Jan
Feb
Mar
Apr
May
Jun
Jul
Aug
Source: World Meteorological Organization
2025 / 2026
2024 / 2025


Surface Soil Moisture (WMO) for Bulgaria
Millimeters
30
25
20
15
10
5
0
Sep
Oct
Nov
Dec
Jan
Feb
Mar
Apr
May
Jun
Jul
Aug
Source: World Meteorological Organization
2025 / 2026
2024 / 2025

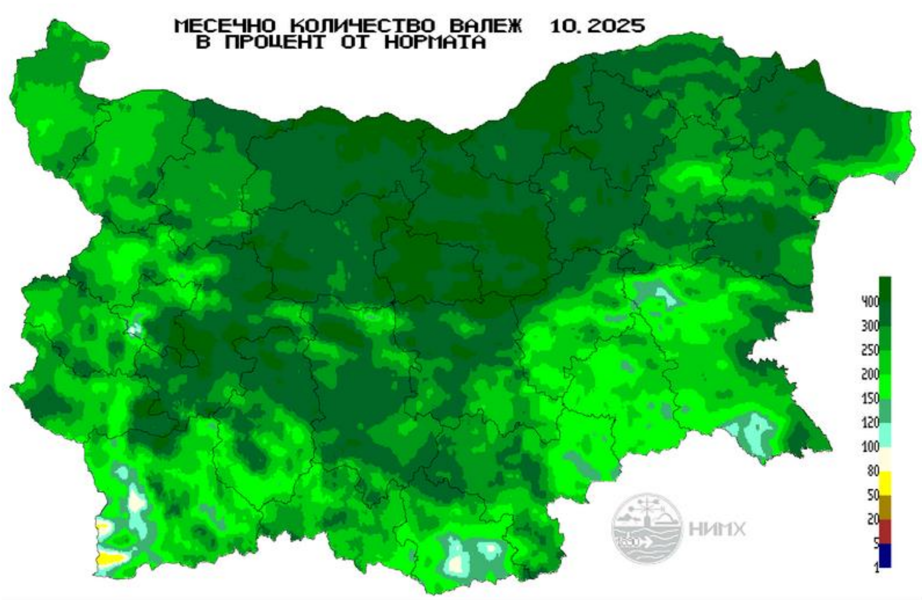


Map 5. October Rainfall 2025



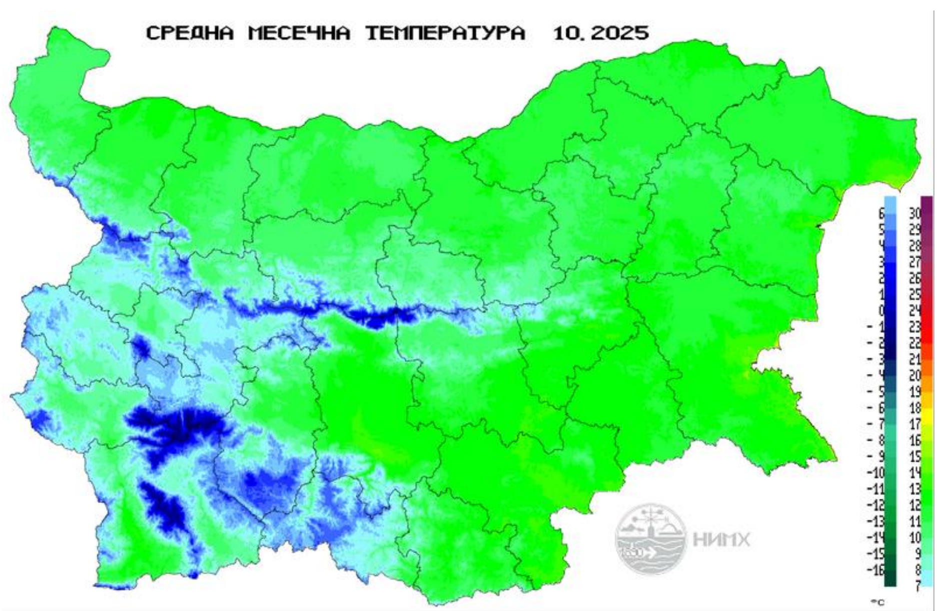
Source: [Bulgarian National Institute of Meteorology and Hydrology]

Map 6. October Rainfall 2025 as a percent of Monthly Norm



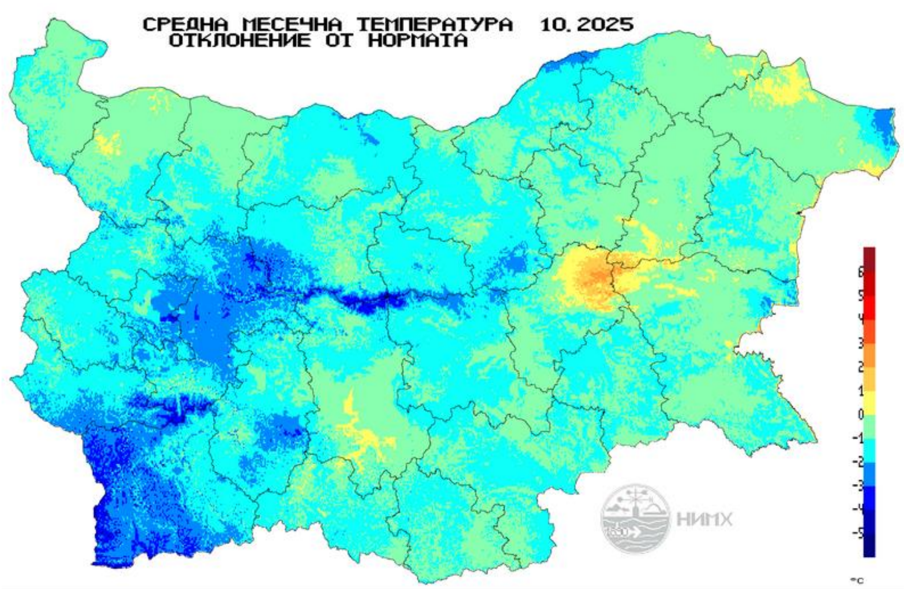
Source: [Bulgarian National Institute of Meteorology and Hydrology]()

Map 7. Average Temperature October 2025



Source: [Bulgarian National Institute of Meteorology and Hydrology]()

Map 8: October 2025: Deviation from the Average Temperature Norm



Source: [Bulgarian National Institute of Meteorology and Hydrology]()

Attachments:

No Attachments.